# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Thursday, September 17, 2026

## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

## THE LIST (5 stories)

### ■ *Matthew Stafford reveals secret behind throws few NFL QBs can make*

***The Angle:*** *Matthew Stafford reveals secret behind throws few NFL QBs can make*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/17/sports/matthew-stafford-reveals-secret-behind-his-incredible-arm-angle-no-look-throws/

### ■ *Ladd McConkey and his wife give shocking news to their family*

***The Angle:*** *The Chargers' breakout receiver is sidelined with an injury, but he and his wife just shared some kind of major family news — the kind of good-news-bad-news split that makes for easy, relatable talk on air.*

**The Guessing Game**

- Baby news, house, ring upgrade — what's your bet on what they just announced?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/17/sports/ladd-mcconkey-and-his-wife-give-shocking-news-to-their-family/

### ■ *Brock Purdy comes up short in hilarious bet with George Kittle*

***The Angle:*** *Two 49ers stars, one dumb rivalry bet gone wrong — Brock Purdy's Iowa State just got embarrassed by George Kittle's Iowa Hawkeyes, and now Purdy's stuck paying up in front of the whole locker room.*

- **Brock Purdy** and **George Kittle** bet each other every year when **Iowa State** and **Iowa** play
- **Iowa** beat **Iowa State 16-13** on Saturday
- Purdy had to face Kittle right after the loss to settle the bet

**The Debate Starter**

- What's the most brutal bet you've ever lost to a coworker or teammate?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/17/sports/brock-purdy-comes-up-short-in-hilarious-bet-with-george-kittle/

### ■ *Blade-wielding 'gangster-ass' crab tries attacking Florida man and his dog: shocking video https://t.co/CUm9Q0RRFa https://t.co/6Eb71wmClE*

***The Angle:*** *It's the kind of only-in-Florida viral video that writes itself for radio — a crab squaring up like it's got a weapon, caught on camera, tailor-made for a quick laugh-and-react moment.*

- A Florida man and his dog were reportedly confronted by a crab described as **'blade-wielding'** and **'gangster-ass'**
- The encounter was caught on video, which is now going viral online
- The clip was flagged by the **New York Post's** social feed as a must-see, shock-factor moment

**The Phone-In Trigger**

- What's the most unhinged animal standoff you've ever had in your own yard?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2100763590441439625

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### ■ *We Regret to Inform You Chipotle Is Now Working With Palantir*

***The Angle:*** *Palantir built its name on defense, intelligence, and ICE contracts — now it's reportedly plugged into Chipotle, and the internet is having a field day with the mental whiplash of "burrito bowl" meeting "surveillance tech giant."*

- **Chipotle** is reportedly now working with **Palantir**, the data-analytics company best known for military, intelligence, and government contracts.
- The pairing is blowing up on **Reddit's r/technology**, with users reacting to a fast-casual chain teaming up with a firm more associated with defense and law enforcement work.
- Palantir has been pushing hard into commercial and retail data deals lately, but this one's got people doing a double-take.

**The Debate Starter**

- Does it creep you out that a company known for military and ICE contracts might now be crunching data on your burrito order?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://newrepublic.com/post/215501/chipotle-palantir

Backup options:

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### ■ *Hackers find encryption keys stored on stolen Flock camera despite company's denials--group extracts more than 27,000 clips, 1.6 million images captured in a span of 21 days from the device*

***The Angle:*** *Flock Safety cameras are bolted onto street corners in thousands of towns tracking license plates for police, and the company swore the data was locked down tight - so hackers proving otherwise by pulling over a million images off a stolen unit is a real 'wait, WHAT' moment for anyone who's driven past one.*

- Hackers say they found **encryption keys stored right on a stolen Flock camera** - despite the company insisting that couldn't happen.
- The group extracted more than **27,000 video clips**.
- Also pulled **1.6 million images** off the single device.
- All of that came from just **21 days** of footage on one camera.

**The Debate Starter**

- If a hacker can crack one stolen camera and walk away with 1.6 million photos, how comfortable are you with these things scanning every plate in your neighborhood?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/cyber-security/hackers-find-encryption-key-stored-on-flock-camera-group-extracts-more-than-27-000-clips-1-6-million-images-captured-in-a-span-of-21-days-from-device

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### ■ *Marvel's Wolverine motorcycle section and quicktime events are getting the wrong kind of attention because "the game plays itself" and "you don't have to press anything"*

***The Angle:*** *Marvel's Wolverine motorcycle section and quicktime events are getting the wrong kind of attention because "the game plays itself" and "you don't have to press anything"*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.gamesradar.com/games/action/marvels-wolverine-motorcycle-section-and-quicktime-events-are-getting-the-wrong-kind-of-attention-because-the-game-plays-itself-and-you-dont-have-to-press-anything/

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### ■ *Shopify CEO says employees' 'slop grenades' are making more work for everyone else*

***The Angle:*** *A tech CEO just put a name to something office workers everywhere have felt but couldn't articulate - lazy AI output getting dumped on a coworker's desk to clean up. It's a workplace-culture flashpoint that goes way beyond one company.*

- **Shopify's CEO** publicly called out staff for tossing '**slop grenades**' into the workflow.
- His point: low-effort, **AI-generated work** doesn't save time - it just shifts the cleanup burden onto someone else.
- The phrase '**slop grenades**' is catching fire online as the new shorthand for sloppy AI shortcuts at work.

**The Debate Starter**

- Callers: have you ever gotten handed a coworker's half-baked AI 'slop grenade' - and had to clean up the mess?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Name That Slop Grenade** - 60-90 seconds, phone/text-in -> Hosts ask listeners to text in their best - or worst - example of getting handed obviously lazy AI-generated work at their job.
- **Step 2: Host Confession** - Quick back-and-forth -> Each host admits whether they've ever lobbed a 'slop grenade' of their own - a rushed email, report, or reply they didn't proofread.
- **Step 3: The Verdict** - Wrap-up take -> Hosts debate: is AI making work faster, or just making messes for other people to fix?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/shopify-ceo-ai-slop-grenades-can-make-work-harder-2026-9

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## CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

### ■■ *I drew Canada as a LOTR/Tolkien fantasy map*

***The Angle:*** *A fan artist turned the entire country into a hand-drawn Tolkien-style fantasy map and it's blowing up on r/Canada — pure nerdy Canadian pride that's perfect for a fun, shareable segment.*

- Artist posted a **Lord of the Rings-style fantasy map of Canada** on **r/Canada**
- They joked, apologizing in advance **"for missing or misspelling any towns"**
- You can buy a **print on Redbubble** of the map, titled **"Realm of Canada"**
- Artist runs an Instagram, **@realmofmaps**, full of similar fantasy-style maps

**The Show and Tell**

- Ask listeners: if our city got the Middle-earth treatment, what fantasy name would it deserve — and would it be Rivendell or Mordor?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Pull up the map** - 30 seconds, cold open -> Hosts describe what they're looking at on screen — a hand-drawn fantasy map with Canadian cities relabeled as kingdoms, mountains, and strongholds.
- **Step 2: Guess the Middle-earth match** - 1-2 minutes -> Hosts each pick a major Canadian city (Toronto, Calgary, Halifax) and riff on what LOTR location it should be — Shire, Mordor, Gondor — and argue it out.
- **Step 3: Open the phone lines** - Caller bit -> Invite listeners to call in and pitch a fantasy name for their own hometown, funniest pitch gets a shoutout.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1wj0mei

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### ■ *Spain’s PM posts image of maple leaf on EU flag. Live updates here.*

***The Angle:*** *A European head of government publicly folding Canada's maple leaf into the EU flag is a striking, symbolic gesture - the kind of image that reads as a diplomatic wink and gets people asking what message is really being sent.*

- **Spain's Prime Minister** shared an image combining a **maple leaf** with the **EU flag**
- The post is being tracked as a live, developing story
- Details on the exact context and timing are still limited

**The Read-Between-The-Lines Bit**

- Is this genuine solidarity with Canada, a jab at someone else, or just a PM having fun online - what's your read?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/politics/article/canadian-pm-welcomes-eus-ambition-for-associate-membership-after-trump-outburst-live-updates-here/

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### ■ *Carney nods to Trump, says Canada, Europe not 'fair-weather allies' in speech to European Parliament | CBC News*

***The Angle:*** *PM Mark Carney took a not-so-subtle swipe at Trump-style alliance-hopping in a speech to the European Parliament, framing Canada and Europe as the steady, reliable partners - a live storyline as Canada navigates its own tense trade relationship with Washington.*

- **Mark Carney** delivered the speech directly to the **European Parliament**
- He said Canada and Europe are not "**fair-weather allies**"
- The line is widely read as a veiled dig at **Donald Trump**'s unpredictable approach to allies

**The Debate Starter**

- Is Carney smart to publicly cozy up to Europe while trying to keep the peace with Trump on trade, or is that playing with fire?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/carney-addresses-eu-parliament-9.7346339

Backup options:

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### ■■ *Manitoba to stick with daylight time year-round*

***The Angle:*** *Manitoba's ditching the twice-a-year clock change and locking in daylight time year-round, reigniting the national debate over whether Canada should just kill the time change for good.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you want your province to make the same move, even if it means sunrise in the dead of winter feels like the middle of the night?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/canada/article-manitoba-daylight-time-year-round/

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### ■ *Associated Press: Carney to address EU Parliament after Trump calls Canada associate membership a possible hostile act*

***The Angle:*** *Canada's PM is set to speak directly to the EU Parliament, and Trump has already called the idea of Canada cozying up to Europe a 'possible hostile act' — that's about as blunt as trade tension talk gets between allies.*

- **Mark Carney** is scheduled to address the **EU Parliament** directly.
- The move follows reported talk of Canada pursuing some form of **'associate membership'** with the EU.
- **Donald Trump** has publicly floated that such a move could be seen as a **'possible hostile act.'**
- It's the latest flashpoint in the ongoing **US-Canada trade and diplomacy tension** under the new administration.

**The Debate Starter**

- Should Canada be looking to Europe for backup, or is picking a fight with Trump over it just bad strategy?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/carney-canada-eu-trump-parliament-speech-ef4559ce5972abb47444e469f42005bb

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### ■ *PM Carney says Canada welcomes ambition to deepen alliance with Europe*

***The Angle:*** *With trade tensions and unpredictability south of the border, Carney signaling a deeper Canada-Europe alliance taps into the bigger "who's Canada's best friend now" conversation everyone's already having.*

- **PM Mark Carney** says Canada "welcomes" ambition to deepen its alliance with **Europe**
- Comes amid a broader push from Ottawa to diversify trade and security ties beyond the U.S.

**The Debate Starter**

- Should Canada be cozying up to Europe more than the U.S. right now — yes or no?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/politics/article/pm-carney-says-canada-welcomes-ambition-to-deepen-alliance-with-europe/

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## ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

### ■ *Viral Horny Pumpkin Song Not That Horny, Insists Horny Guy Who Wrote It*

***The Angle:*** *A pumpkin-themed song went viral for its cheeky innuendo, and now the guy who wrote it is doing damage control, insisting it's tamer than everyone thinks - which is exactly the kind of internet-goes-too-literal moment hosts can have fun with.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Can a song title alone make something 'too horny' before anyone's even heard the lyrics?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/viral-horny-pumpkin-song-not-that-horny-insists-horny-guy-who-wrote-it-2000813453

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### ■ *Colin Farrell Looks Unrecognizable with Shaved Head in Shocking Transformation - people.com*

***The Angle:*** *A total shaved-head transformation from a recognizable leading man is easy, visual, water-cooler fodder — perfect for a quick "did you see this photo" moment on air.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Bold new look or better off keeping the hair — where do you land on **Colin Farrell's** shaved head?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMihgFBVV95cUxQVjNTRkg5YTVmNkZxRUdwbkp2empuSGlQTURFdGFMWDlOMkVLTkhzXzJfdHh5ZFR5Q3NvWnh3SHpjTTBvY1A0SUk3U0UtQXctZXUwVkpLRjc2OVh6T3A0bEFTR21xVHIzQUNtVkFKdEM0WjVudFFWZG9VYmlFd1FqZExxSU9ZQQ?oc=5

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### ■ *Karol G Scores First Multi-Week No. 1 on Billboard Global Charts With ‘BbY WOW’*

***The Angle:*** *Karol G's track 'BbY WOW' is holding the No. 1 spot on Billboard's Global Charts for a second straight week — her first-ever multi-week global chart-topper, a big career milestone for the reggaeton superstar.*

- **Karol G** scores her **first-ever multi-week No. 1** on the **Billboard Global Charts**
- The song holding the top spot: **'BbY WOW'**
- Marks a new career milestone for the Colombian superstar on the global stage

**The Fan Cam**

- Is 'BbY WOW' actually her best song, or just her best-timed one?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2100704734877262043

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### ■ *New Documentary Film Argues That Bible References to Homosexuality Are Mistranslations*

***The Angle:*** *A new documentary is reopening one of the oldest culture-war debates by arguing the Bible verses used to condemn homosexuality are the result of bad translations, not scripture itself — guaranteed to spark strong reactions from both sides of the aisle.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Do you think this doc changes any minds, or does everyone just retreat to their same corner?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.moviemaker.com/1946-bible-homosexuality-mistranslation/

Backup options:

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### ■ *Millie Bobby Brown Welcomes Baby No. 2 with Husband Jake Bongiovi*

***The Angle:*** *The Stranger Things star and her husband, Jake Bongiovi, are growing their family again - a rare feel-good celebrity moment that's easy, breezy pop-culture chat for the show.*

- **Millie Bobby Brown** and husband **Jake Bongiovi** have welcomed their second child together
- **Jake Bongiovi** is the son of rock icon **Jon Bon Jovi**
- The couple, who married in 2024, are now a family of four

**The Feel-Good Chat**

- Two under two for Millie Bobby Brown - what's the wildest celebrity baby name you're bracing for next?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/millie-bobby-brown-welcomes-second-baby-with-husband-jake-bongiovi-source-12125396?utm_campaign=peoplemagazine&utm_medium=social&utm_source=reddit.com&utm_content=post

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### ■ *'You're Not Going To Win Tonight With That Stupid Face': Ke Huy Quan Reveals Cruel Dig From Famous Actor*

***The Angle:*** *Everyone loves Ke Huy Quan's comeback story, so hearing a brutal, catty insult from an unnamed A-lister is instant gossip fuel — and the mystery of who said it makes it even juicier.*

- **Ke Huy Quan** says a famous actor told him: **'You're not going to win tonight with that stupid face.'**
- Quan hasn't publicly named who said it, leaving fans to speculate.
- The line reads like classic old-school Hollywood pettiness aimed at an awards contender.

**The Guessing Game**

- Who do you think said it to him — drop your guess on the phones.

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Read The Insult Cold** - 30 seconds, no context first -> One host reads the quote flat, deadpan, then reveals it's Ke Huy Quan sharing it about himself.
- **Step 2: Guess The Actor** - 2-3 minutes -> Hosts each throw out a guess for who they think said it, based on reputation for shade.
- **Step 3: Open The Phone Lines** - Ongoing -> Ask listeners to call or text their guess for who delivered the dig.

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/ke-huy-quan-unnamed-actor-sag-awards-memoir-1764162

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### ■■ *NBA player Kyrie Irving to ESPN: "Her name is HIND RAJAB. And She was more brave than every single one of you at ESPN"*

***The Angle:*** *Kyrie Irving is never shy about controversy, and this direct shot at ESPN invoking the Israel-Gaza conflict is guaranteed to reignite the debate over athletes mixing sports and politics.*

- **Kyrie Irving** called out **ESPN** directly, referencing a name tied to the Gaza conflict.
- His exact quote: **"Her name is HIND RAJAB. And she was more brave than every single one of you at ESPN."**

**The Debate Starter**

- Should athletes use their platform for political statements like this, or is it a line they shouldn't cross with the media?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/34i49qfvr4qh1.png

### ■ *In the wake of the Ed Sheeran controversy, bbno$ wants to throw a charity concert for Palestine*

***The Angle:*** *A viral pop star controversy is now spilling into other artists' actions — bbno$ jumping in with his own charity concert idea turns a one-off scandal into an industry-wide conversation about musicians and politics.*

- **bbno$** (the Canadian rapper behind "Edamame") is reportedly floating a charity concert benefiting **Palestine**
- The idea comes directly in response to the recent **Ed Sheeran** controversy
- Story is circulating on **r/fauxmoi**, a hotbed for celebrity gossip and reactions

**The Debate Starter**

- Should musicians be using their platform for political charity moves, or should artists just stick to the music?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/8qaeq4uts3qh1

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## TRENDING TODAY

### ■ *Woman’s Mugshot Is Going Viral as Commenters Claim She Resembles Jennifer Lopez - people.com*

***The Angle:*** *A random mugshot blew up online because commenters swear the woman is a dead ringer for Jennifer Lopez — it's the kind of goofy internet rabbit hole that's tailor-made for a quick photo debate on air.*

- A woman's **mugshot** started circulating online and went viral
- Commenters flooded the post claiming she's a lookalike for **Jennifer Lopez**

**The Debate Starter**

- Pull up the photo on air — do your listeners see JLo, or is the internet reaching?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Show the Photo** - Cold open, no context -> Hosts pull up the mugshot on the show's social feed/screen without saying who it's compared to and ask co-host for a first reaction.
- **Step 2: Reveal the Comparison** - 30 seconds -> Tell them the internet is saying Jennifer Lopez — get their honest yes/no take.
- **Step 3: Phone/Text Poll** - Live audience vote -> Ask listeners to text in 'JLo' or 'Nah' and read a few responses on air.

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMijwFBVV95cUxPVE1hNFBnellRYWc0X3ZTYmVibnVkN200eTc3WUR1a3BaR3ctMnk3MWNZUGd1TG1haW41aExRamg5QUxpdmxOSGRRUFcwX2NPejJrU2lOLTZQbk9nTFpualV6RmlVaXRGQUJuQURhLU0ybUkzbERzTEhXeVRjNVFCakpxX0lNODIzQm5kZUlqOA?oc=5

Backup options:

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### ■ *Erin Tatum, a TikTok-famous woman with cerebral palsy, slams Ed Sheeran*

***The Angle:*** *A viral TikTok creator known for disability advocacy is calling out one of the biggest pop stars on the planet — that's an instant clash of a huge fanbase and a huge platform, which is exactly the kind of internet beef that gets people talking.*

- **Erin Tatum**, a TikTok creator known for her advocacy around living with **cerebral palsy**, is publicly criticizing **Ed Sheeran**.
- The callout is circulating on **r/fauxmoi**, a subreddit built around celebrity gossip and receipts.
- Exact details of what sparked the criticism aren't confirmed yet — worth digging up before you go deep on air.

**The Debate Starter**

- When a creator with a huge platform calls out a superstar, who do you side with by default — the celebrity or the advocate?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/c7irfhlty1qh1

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## LIFESTYLE CHAT

### ■ *Bleeding Gums Linked to 61% Higher Alzheimer's Risk in 10-Year Study: In a long-term study in Japan, bleeding and receding gums were linked to substantially higher risk of dementia. Emerging evidence is linking gum disease and oral microbes with changes to neurological tissue and cognitive function.*

***The Angle:*** *A 10-year Japanese study says bleeding, receding gums could raise your Alzheimer's risk by 61% - a story that turns everyday flossing guilt into a real gut-check about brain health.*

- **10-year study out of Japan** tracked gum health against dementia outcomes
- People with **bleeding or receding gums** showed a **61% higher risk** of developing Alzheimer's
- Researchers point to **oral bacteria** potentially traveling to and altering **neurological tissue**
- The link ties everyday **gum disease** to changes in long-term **cognitive function**

**The Guilt Trip**

- Be honest - when's the last time you actually flossed, and does this headline change that tonight?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/bleeding-gums-linked-to-61-higher-alzheimers-risk-in-10-year-study

Backup options:

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### ■ *Just smelling coffee may be enough to alter mood and brain activity, according to new research. Scientists found that coffee aroma alone can influence attention, alertness, and cognitive processing—even without drinking a single sip.*

***The Angle:*** *New research says the mere scent of coffee can shift your mood, focus, and brain activity before you take a single sip — the kind of 'wait, really?' science that makes for an easy, relatable chat since basically everyone in the audience has a coffee ritual.*

- **New research** found that **coffee aroma alone** — no drinking involved — was enough to influence attention and alertness.
- Scientists measured actual shifts in **brain activity** and **cognitive processing** triggered just by the smell.
- The effect appeared regardless of whether people went on to actually drink the coffee.

**The Sniff Test**

- Be honest — do you actually need the caffeine, or does just smelling coffee wake you up?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Brew It Live** - Set up before the segment -> Have a fresh pot brewing in studio so the aroma's already in the air when you introduce the story.
- **Step 2: The Sniff, No Sip** - On mic -> Both hosts smell the coffee without drinking it and narrate whether they instantly feel more alert or focused.
- **Step 3: Phone Lines Open** - Audience participation -> Ask listeners to call or text: does the smell alone actually perk you up, or is it all placebo?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/just-smelling-coffee-may-change-your-mood-and-brain-activity

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## CLOSER: THROWBACK THURSDAY

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### ■ *Selena Gomez Says She and 'Joyful' Husband Benny Blanco Are Still in 'Honeymoon Stage' Ahead of First Anniversary (Exclusive) - people.com*

***The Angle:*** *Selena Gomez and Benny Blanco are about to hit their first wedding anniversary, and she's telling People they're still giddy in love — a feel-good celebrity check-in that's easy, relatable water-cooler talk for the show.*

- **Selena Gomez** opened up to **People** in an exclusive ahead of her **first wedding anniversary** with **Benny Blanco**.
- She calls him her **"joyful"** husband.
- Gomez says the two are still very much in the **"honeymoon stage"** even as year one wraps up.

**The Aww Factor**

- What's the real expiration date on the honeymoon phase — and did yours last past year one?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 69/90 (40 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiqAFBVV95cUxNN0o0Qy1oZUFsZ2RwOWdEQ2pCV0tZbmxiYUc5bUpEMEk0Wk5US0VhWHByVHpFREh4NkNiTEdDWDFMdG9JRmJLOGlCMHBQRFVZeGtoTW0tZlNKU3N5WnkyczA3RXl0dDVaZnBiZjVBMlk4d2pYTzdheEZPWmlNRzJRUmZyM2x4amRwU2Nycm5zTTJaUkd4Rlg0M0xvNWdTWGlyYkJsU2V6cVY?oc=5

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## FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

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## ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

### ■■ *Ukraine is using solar power to stay resilient as Russia attacks its electricity grid. The country added 1.5 GW of new solar in 2025, nearly twice the previous year, while rooftop panels and batteries are helping homes, businesses and communities keep essential power during outages.*

***The Angle:*** *Russia keeps bombing Ukraine's power grid, so regular people are clapping back with rooftop solar and batteries - it's resilience turned into a national energy strategy, and it's the kind of good-news-in-a-war-zone story that stops you mid-scroll.*

- Ukraine added **1.5 gigawatts** of new solar power in **2025**
- That's nearly **double** the amount installed the year before
- Rooftop panels and home batteries are keeping the lights on for **homes, businesses, and whole communities** during Russian-caused outages
- It's a grassroots workaround to an active attack on the country's electricity grid

**The Silver Lining Angle**

- Necessity really is the mother of invention - a country under attack is out-innovating a lot of places that aren't.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://grist.org/international/as-russia-attacks-ukraines-grid-solar-offers-a-path-to-resilience/

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### ■ *Indonesia is paying villagers to photograph wildlife instead of hunt it, helping turn animal hunters into protectors. The programme has already generated more than 350,000 wildlife observations, and two participating villages have voluntarily banned hunting.*

***The Angle:*** *It's the ultimate 'flip the incentive' story — hunters turned into wildlife photographers, and it's actually working, with entire villages giving up hunting on their own.*

- The program pays **villagers in Indonesia** to **photograph wildlife instead of hunting it**
- It's already logged more than **350,000 wildlife observations**
- **Two participating villages** have **voluntarily banned hunting** altogether

**The Feel-Good Follow-Up**

- Would you trade your rifle for a camera if it paid the same?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://english.aawsat.com/varieties/5319326-indonesia-cash-photos-scheme-turns-animal-hunters-protectors

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### ■ *Cody Rhodes Reveals Wearable Popcorn Bucket For 'Street Fighter'*

***The Angle:*** *Wearable movie popcorn buckets keep getting weirder and more viral, and a WWE star fronting one for the new 'Street Fighter' movie is exactly the kind of only-in-2026 merch that gets people talking online.*

- **Cody Rhodes** — the WWE star — revealed the item
- It's a **wearable popcorn bucket** tied to the new **'Street Fighter'** movie
- Fits the trend of movie theaters pushing outlandish, wearable popcorn buckets as collectibles

**The Watercooler Take**

- Rate the wearable popcorn bucket trend: genius merch or peak movie-theater cash grab?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fightful.com/wrestling/cody-rhodes-reveals-wearable-guile-popcorn-bucket-for-street-fighter/

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## BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

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### ■ *Researchers use genetically engineered immune cells to put a child's metastatic cancer into remission*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Same child-cancer-remission story is independently trending on both Reddit and Gizmodo (see #48) simultaneously, a cross-platform convergence signal that usually precedes a breakout.
***The Angle:*** *A child's cancer that had already spread went into remission after doctors engineered the kid's own immune cells to hunt it down - the kind of science-fiction-turned-real story that makes for an easy feel-good chat.*

- Doctors used **genetically engineered immune cells** to treat the case
- The cancer was **metastatic**, meaning it had already spread in the body
- The child's cancer reportedly went into **remission** following treatment

**The Feel-Good Moment**

- This is one of those 'science is wild' stories - anyone else feel like we're living in the medical future we were promised?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 53/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality - 25 penalty (used within the last 30 days)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113869-researchers-use-genetically-engineered-immune-cells-put-child.html

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### ■■ *3-Year-Old Boy's Cancer Disappears After He Gets Experimental Immunotherapy https://t.co/rTj7WcS6v0*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Duplicate pickup of this exact remission story on Reddit (#4) at the same time suggests organic cross-platform momentum rather than a one-off post.
***The Angle:*** *A miracle medical story with instant mass appeal — a toddler's cancer disappearing after a cutting-edge immunotherapy trial is the kind of good-news headline that stops people scrolling and gets shared everywhere.*

- The patient is just **3 years old**
- He received an **experimental immunotherapy** treatment
- His cancer **disappeared** following the treatment, according to the report

**The Feel-Good Hook**

- Ask listeners: any of you had a family member's health turn around thanks to a clinical trial or experimental treatment?

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2100696447070908674

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## ■ *River with 500 crocodiles in it will be used for rowing at Olympics*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Two independent posts on the same subreddit-type ('crocodile river approved for Olympic rowing') signal the absurdist premise is spontaneously resurfacing, and 'hundreds of crocodiles at the Olympics' is exactly the kind of surreal headline that gets screenshotted and shared far outside Reddit.
***The Angle:*** *It's the kind of headline that sounds fake but isn't, which is exactly why r/nottheonion exists - a river packed with 500 crocodiles is apparently getting the green light as an Olympic rowing course.*

- Report says the proposed rowing venue is home to an estimated **500 crocodiles**
- The river would reportedly still be used for **Olympic rowing competition**
- Story is making rounds via **r/nottheonion** for being almost too absurd to believe

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you get in a boat on a river with 500 crocodiles for a gold medal?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-express.com/sport/other-sport/216170/Brisbane-Olympics-500-crocodiles-river-rowing-australia

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## ■ *River crawling with crocodiles is approved as Olympic rowing venue*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): This is the second independent thread on the same wild premise as #5, suggesting the story keeps regenerating engagement each time someone rediscovers it — a classic signal of a sleeper meme about to break wide.
***The Angle:*** *It's the kind of headline that stops you mid-scroll - officials signing off on a crocodile-infested river for Olympic competition is peak 'wait, what?' news that practically writes its own jokes.*

**The Reaction Bit**

- What's the one animal that would make YOU refuse to compete, no matter the medal?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thetimes.com/world/australasia/article/fitzroy-river-crocodile-olympics-brisbane-rowing-zqrfv7rgf

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## ■ *"What Changed?": Activist Launches Movement To Restore O.J. Simpson's Scrubbed Legacy*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): O.J. Simpson is one of the most recognizable and polarizing names in America, and a 'restore his legacy' movement is a ready-made outrage/curiosity hook that reliably drives outsized comment volume even off modest upvotes.
***The Angle:*** *This is a pure 'you can't make this up' r/nottheonion find - an activist reportedly pushing to rehab O.J. Simpson's image is the kind of headline that stops you mid-scroll and demands a reaction.*

**The Reaction Read**

- Just read the headline cold and let the silence - or the laugh - do the work.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.essentiallysports.com/nfl-active-news-buffalo-activist-launches-movement-to-restore-o-j-simpsons-bills-legacy-after-snub/

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### ■ *Students Risk 'Cognitive Surrender' by Relying on AI for Answers*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): 'Cognitive surrender' crystallizes the ongoing AI-in-education anxiety into a sticky, quotable phrase that teachers, parents, and students all have a stake in — the kind of framing that gets repurposed as a talking point well beyond the original post.
***The Angle:*** *New warnings say kids leaning on AI for every answer might be losing the ability to think for themselves — a debate that hits parents, teachers, and anyone who's ever let a chatbot do their thinking.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Ask listeners: when's the last time you asked AI instead of just working it out yourself?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.chosun.com/english/industry-en/2026/09/17/V6LSYDIO2JBOTAJFSKJOBAGUT4/

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## FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 5 banked (+15 each when found)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "The day isn't even close to over and I already am done with it." (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-17)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 19 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary ‘B’Day’ Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "‘A modern Dickie Dee bike’: Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)

Newly banked this run:

- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!"
- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "The day isn't even close to over and I already am done with it."

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## SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-17 11:41 PM